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algolog.co

5 Revenue Leaks Every Serviced Apartment Has

(And How to Plug Them Today)

A Self-Diagnostic Checklist for Hospitality Operators in Nigeria

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Most serviced apartment operators are losing money every month without realising it. Not to theft or bad luck — but to small, invisible inefficiencies that add up over time.

For each leak below, we've included:

- **What it's costing you** — so you can calculate your own losses
- **A free fix you can do today** — something you can implement right now
- **The automated fix** — how to eliminate the leak permanently

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1. **Double-bookings that cost you twice**
2. **Payments that fall through the cracks**
3. **Empty rooms you don't know about**
4. **Staff time wasted on manual tasks**
5. **Check-in friction that kills reviews**

A free checklist by Algolog Limited | spacer.so

1 Double-Bookings That Cost You Twice

When bookings are managed on WhatsApp, phone calls, or spreadsheets, it's only a matter of time before two guests are confirmed for the same room on the same dates. The result: one guest has to be relocated or refunded, and your reputation takes a hit.

What it's costing you: [Your double-bookings per month] × NGN 100,000 average cost per incident. Even one per month = NGN 1.2 million per year.

Free fix — do this today: Create a shared Google Sheet with one column per room and one row per date. Before confirming ANY booking — WhatsApp, phone, or walk-in — check the sheet first. Make it a rule: no confirmation goes out without checking. It's not perfect, but it catches 80% of conflicts.

The automated fix: A centralized booking system that blocks conflicting reservations automatically. No manual checking, no human error, no forgotten updates. Every booking is validated in real time.

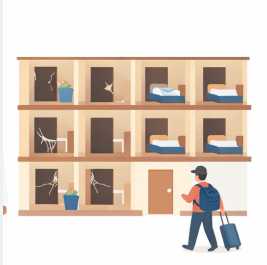
2 Payments That Fall Through the Cracks

A guest confirms on WhatsApp. They say they'll transfer. Your staff forgets to follow up. The payment never arrives, but the room was held. Or worse — the guest pays cash, but the amount isn't recorded properly and gets lost in the daily shuffle.

What it's costing you: [Unpaid or unreconciled bookings per month] × average booking value. If just 3 bookings go unreconciled at NGN 40,000 each = NGN 1.44 million per year.

Free fix — do this today: New rule: no check-in without a payment confirmation screenshot sent to the team group chat. Assign one person to reconcile bank statements against bookings every morning. Track it: Booking | Guest | Expected Amount | Received | Status.

The automated fix: Automated invoicing tied to every booking. Payment confirmation required before check-in is granted. Digital receipts for every transaction. Every naira accounted for automatically.



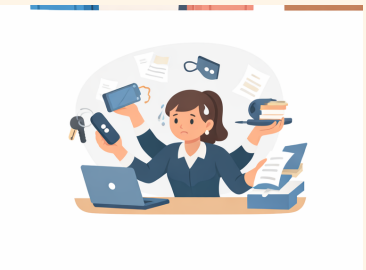
3 Empty Rooms You Don't Know About

If you don't have real-time occupancy data, you can't see which rooms are sitting empty and for how long. You can't fix what you can't see.

What it's costing you: [Empty room-nights per month] × your nightly rate. A room unbooked for just 5 extra days at NGN 30,000/night = NGN 150,000 lost — per room. Across 10 rooms, that's NGN 1.5 million per month.

Free fix — do this today: At the end of every week, count how many room-nights went unbooked. Write it down. Just tracking this number will change how you think about availability. Then ask: could I have filled any of these with a weekend promo or a reduced midweek rate?

The automated fix: A live dashboard showing occupancy rates, availability gaps, and booking trends in real time — so you can adjust pricing or run targeted promotions to fill rooms before they sit empty.



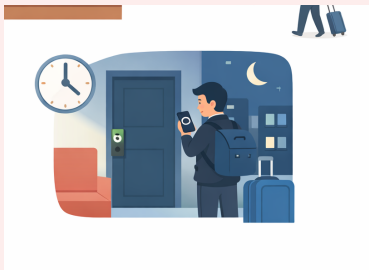
4 Staff Time Wasted on Manual Tasks

Your receptionist spends hours every day answering WhatsApp messages about availability, sending payment details manually, coordinating check-in times, and handing over physical keys. That's hours that could be spent on guest experience, upselling, or operations.

What it's costing you: If your staff spends 3 hours daily on tasks a system could handle, that's over 90 hours a month of paid labour. At NGN 2,000/hour, that's NGN 180,000/month — not counting the revenue those hours could have generated.

Free fix — do this today: Create a WhatsApp Broadcast List with a standard check-in message template. Include: bank account details, check-in time, address, and directions. Copy-paste instead of retyping every time. It saves 30 minutes a day minimum.

The automated fix: Automated booking confirmations, payment links, and access codes sent directly to guests the moment they book. Staff checks a dashboard instead of managing 15 WhatsApp conversations.



5 Check-In Friction That Kills Reviews and Referrals

A guest arrives at 11 PM after a long flight. No one is at reception. Or someone is there, but they can't find the right key. Or the guest has to wait 30 minutes while staff "confirms" the booking on WhatsApp. That first impression shapes everything — the review they leave, whether they come back, and whether they recommend you.

What it's costing you: A bad check-in doesn't just lose one guest — it loses everyone that guest would have referred. One negative review can deter 10+ potential bookings. At NGN 50,000/booking, that's NGN 500,000+ in invisible losses from a single bad experience.

Free fix — do this today: Send every confirmed guest a WhatsApp message 24 hours before check-in with: the exact address, a Google Maps pin, their room number, and the name/phone of whoever will hand them the key. Remove every point of confusion before they arrive.

The automated fix: Smart lock access codes sent automatically after booking. The guest arrives, enters their code, and walks in. No keys, no waiting, no friction — even at 2 AM.

▯ SCORE YOURSELF: HOW MANY LEAKS DO YOU HAVE?

Count how many of these are true for your property:

#	Statement	▯ or ▯
1	We've had at least one double-booking in the last 3 months	
2	We've had payments go missing or unreconciled in the last month	
3	I don't know my exact occupancy rate for last month	
4	Staff spend more than 2 hours daily on WhatsApp for bookings	
5	A guest has complained about check-in in the last 3 months	

0–1: You're in good shape. Small optimizations can still unlock significant revenue.

2–3: You're leaving serious money on the table. A few targeted fixes could recover NGN 500K–1M monthly.

4–5: These leaks are likely costing you NGN 1–3 million per month. The sooner you act, the more you recover.

▯ WANT HELP PLUGGING THESE LEAKS?

We offer a free 15-minute Property Tech Audit — a quick, focused conversation where we review how your property currently operates and identify exactly which leaks are costing you the most.

We only do 10 of these per month, so we can give each property our full attention.

No obligation. No pressure. Just a useful conversation.

Book your free audit:

Call/WhatsApp: Yasmin Umar — +234 706 905 7925
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This checklist was prepared by Algolog Limited, a Nigerian technology company that builds management systems for hospitality and workspace businesses. Our platform, Spacer (spacer.so), is currently managing 500+ bookings monthly across properties in Abuja and Kaduna.

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